CHAPTER 5

SECURITY IN THE CONTEMPORARY WORLD

CHAPTER ESSENCE AT A GLANCE:
Examine the changing architecture of security, contrasting traditional state-centric military doctrines (deterrence, balance of power, alliances, arms control) with non-traditional human and global security dimensions addressing terrorism, pandemics, mass migration, and poverty.

4 CORE PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

• **Traditional Security Paradigms:** Focuses on military threats to state sovereignty and territorial integrity, operationalized through deterrence (preventing war), defense (limiting damage), balance of power, and military alliances.

• **Traditional Arms Control and Disarmament:** International treaties designed to prevent catastrophic conflict, including the Biological Weapons Convention (1972), Chemical Weapons Convention (1992), and the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (1968).

• **Non-Traditional Human Security:** Broadens security to protect individual human beings rather than just national territories, encompassing freedom from fear (violence and civil war) and freedom from want (hunger, disease, and poverty).

• **India's Comprehensive Security Strategy:** Anchored in four synchronized pillars: upgrading national military defense capabilities, building international multilateral norms, safeguarding internal territorial cohesion, and pursuing inclusive socio-economic development.

ESSENTIAL CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLES & THEORIES

$$\text{Traditional Security Model} \iff \text{Deterrence} + \text{Defense} + \text{Balance of Power} + \text{Alliances}$$

External Military Mechanics of State Survival

$$\text{Non-Traditional Security Matrix} \iff \text{Human Security (Freedom from Fear and Want)} + \text{Global Security}$$

People-Centred Paradigms Transcending Territorial Borders

$$\text{Arms Control Architecture} \iff \{\text{NPT (1968)}, \quad \text{BWC (1972)}, \quad \text{CWC (1992)}, \quad \text{START Treaties}\}$$

Multilateral Regimes Governing Weapons of Mass Destruction

$$\text{India Security Strategy} \iff \text{Military Capability} + \text{International Norms} + \text{Internal Harmony} + \text{Economic Growth}$$

Four Interdependent Pillars of India's Strategic Doctrine

CRUCIAL EXAM PRECAUTIONS & VALUATION RUBRIC SECRETS

• **Alert:** Never confuse deterrence with defense: deterrence aims at preventing an adversary from attacking by threatening unbearable retaliation, whereas defense aims to halt and defeat an attack that has already commenced.

• **Alert:** Remember that human security shifts the referent object of security from the state to the individual human being.

• **Alert:** Do not describe non-traditional threats as solvable purely by national armed forces; challenges like global warming and viral pandemics require multilateral cooperation.

HIGH-YIELD CENTUM QUESTIONS & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS

1. Distinguish between traditional and non-traditional notions of security. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Traditional Security:** Concerned primarily with military threats directed against the sovereignty, territorial integrity, and political independence of the state. **[1 Mark]**

• **Non-Traditional Security:** Goes beyond military threats to protect individuals and communities from non-military dangers such as hunger, infectious diseases, environmental collapse, and terrorism. **[1 Mark]**

2. What are Confidence Building Measures (CBMs) in the context of traditional security? [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Definition:** Institutionalized processes through which rival states share military information, intentions, and force deployment data to reduce mistrust. **[1 Mark]**

• **Objective:** Designed to prevent accidental military clashes, remove mutual suspicions, and ensure that neither state launches a surprise pre-emptive attack. **[1 Mark]**

3. Explain three major external traditional security components utilized by sovereign states. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Deterrence:** Building military might and retaliatory capacity to dissuade potential adversaries from launching an attack. **[1 Mark]**

• **Balance of Power:** Maintaining strategic military and economic parity with rival states through domestic industrial build-up or diplomatic partnerships. **[1 Mark]**

• **Alliance Building:** Forming formal coalitions of states codified in mutual defense treaties (such as NATO) to deter common security threats. **[1 Mark]**

4. Discuss the two prominent interpretations of 'Human Security' in contemporary international discourse. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Narrow Interpretation (Freedom from Fear):** Focuses on protecting individuals from direct violent threats such as armed conflict, civil warfare, state terrorism, and human rights violations. **[1.5 Marks]**

• **Broad Interpretation (Freedom from Want):** Expands the concept to include economic security, food availability, healthcare, protection from environmental disasters, and freedom from crushing poverty. **[1.5 Marks]**

5. Analyze terrorism as a major non-traditional threat to contemporary global security. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Nature and Modus Operandi:** Involves systematic, premeditated political violence directed intentionally against unarmed civilians to create mass terror and force concessions from governments. **[1 Mark]**

• **Transnational Reach:** Modern terrorist networks operate across borders using advanced encrypted communications, illegal financial hawala networks, and global media. **[1 Mark]**

• **Global Impact:** Watershed events like the September 11 attacks transformed international security agendas, demanding multilateral intelligence sharing and counter-terror protocols. **[1 Mark]**

6. Detail the four distinct components of India's national security strategy since Independence. [Score: 4 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Strengthening Military Capabilities:** Modernizing armed forces and maintaining nuclear deterrence to guard borders against external aggression from hostile neighbours. **[1 Mark]**

• **Strengthening International Norms:** Actively championing non-alignment, decolonisation, universal disarmament, and multilateral rules-based diplomacy through the United Nations. **[1 Mark]**

• **Managing Internal Security:** Preserving national integration by resolving secessionist and insurgent challenges through democratic accommodation and federal devolution. **[1 Mark]**

• **Socio-Economic Development:** Transforming the domestic economy to lift millions out of poverty, recognizing that acute economic inequality breeds social instability. **[1 Mark]**

7. Explain why health epidemics and global environmental degradation are classified as non-traditional global security threats. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Disregard for National Borders:** Infectious viral diseases such as COVID-19, SARS, and avian flu cross sovereign frontiers seamlessly through air travel and trade. **[1 Mark]**

• **Catastrophic Human Loss:** Pandemics and extreme climate events kill more people than conventional wars, causing economic dislocation, supply chain breakdown, and societal panic. **[1 Mark]**

• **Requirement for Multilateral Action:** No single nation can secure itself in isolation; containment requires global vaccine coordination, shared genomic data, and joint climate funding. **[1 Mark]**